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industry level, how closely is the industry working with the government?

A: This must be a collaborative effort right now. The good thing is that the Department of Fertilizers is on the ball with the industry daily. The good thing about this collaboration is that it helps in addressing issues that we have had over the last three to four years and have managed to come out of. Be it small or large player, everyone's opinion is sought, and discussions take place continuously.

The government is as concerned, and rightly so, about availability and ensuring that the farmers' needs are met. One is really speaking of food security, and here, both the government and industry have important roles to play. **As I said, the next crop is not going to be an issue. I hope the problems are sorted out soon to ensure we are well-placed after that.**

Q: What else can the industry do to mitigate some of these risks?

A: Whether we like it or not, the fertiliser industry imports most of its raw material. This comes with a certain amount of risk. If it continues that way, we need to see what can be done. For phosphoric acid, I don't think we will have a problem in India. A lot of urea comes through the Strait of Hormuz, and we will need to see how that plays out.

Q: What is your view on nano fertilisers? How much of a difference will it make?

A: There's been a lot of talk on nano fertilisers, and we have had a good run with it. We feel nano is a good product and must be applied correctly. **The proof of the pudding is in the eating. The farmers have used our nano fertilisers and are swearing by them. The application is also easy. It's done through a drone. It is catching on quickly.**

Q: Coromandel has been a multi-bagger stock over the last decade and a half. Keeping that in mind, how would you view this phase for shareholders?

A: We can't be oblivious to what is happening here or the West Asia crisis. There will be some impact. A good company will need to mitigate that by taking some actions. On raw material coverage, I don't see too much of an issue. But with the rupee going the way it is, we need to understand how it plays out. That is important since we are hugely import-dependent.